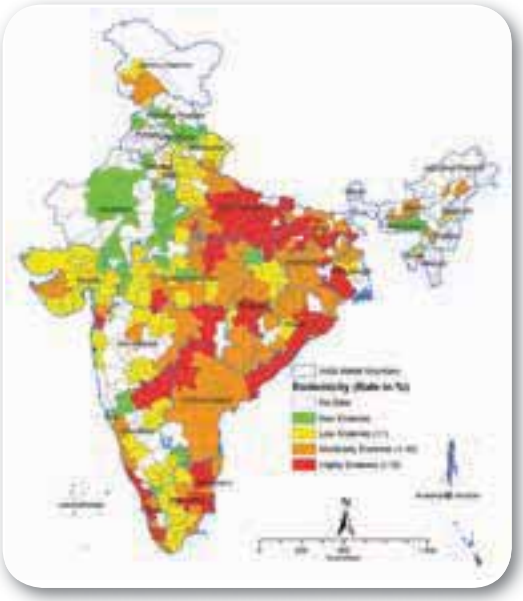
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Filariasis has been a major public health problem in India next only to malaria. The disease was recorded in India as early as 6th century B.C. by the famous Indian physician, Susruta in his book **Susruta Samhita.** In 7th century A.D., **Madhavakara** described signs and symptoms of the disese in his treatise ' Madhava Nidhana' which holds good even today. In 1709, Clarke identified elephantoid legs in Cochin. The microfilariae in the peripheral blood was first identified by Lewis in 1872 in Calcutta (Kolkata).

in Earthworms, and suckers in Leech help in locomotion. The circulatory system is of closed type and the respiratory pigments are hemoglobin and chlorocruorin. Nervous system consists of paired ganglion connected by the lateral nerves to the double ventral nerve cord. They reproduce sexually. Development is direct or indirect and includes a trochophore larva. Some are monoecious (earthworms) while some are dioecious (Neries and Leech). (Figure 2.14)

Examples: *Lampito mauritii* (earthworm), *Neries* (sand worm), *Hirudinaria* (leech).

How is cephalisation advantageous to animals in finding food?

2.3.7 Phylum: Arthropoda

(G. *arthros*- jointed; podes- feet)

This is the largest phylum of the Kingdom Animalia and includes the largest class called Insecta (total species ranges from 2-10 million). They are bilaterally symmetrical, segmented, triploblastic and schizocoelomate animals with organ system grade of body organisation. They have jointed appendages which are used for locomotion,



Earthworm



Nereis



Leech

Figure 2.14 Examples of Annelida